

Machines don't hit numbers. People do.

XLA by Design — an outcome-based approach to workplace experience, and the offering structure it calls for.

A directional read for Launch's POV on XLA. For internal alignment only.

A POV built **for the co-creation** — not a finished offering.

The brief charged us with co-creating a joint Launch + DWS offering that makes the SLA → XLA push real. **This is my input to that work — deliberately opinionated so we have something sharp to react to together.** Five things to hold as you read:

- 1 Input, not output.** This is Launch's contribution to the joint offering — a starting point for the co-creation with DWS, not a replacement for it.
- 2 Additive to DWS, by design.** DWS names the destination; we're the execution layer that makes it real. This is the brief's own “why Launch + DWS” logic, built out.
- 3 One challenge to the brief: pricing.** The brief benchmarks a fixed sprint. I want to make the case for pricing to the *outcome* instead — and get your read on it. That's the signal I most want.
- 4 The core, not the whole package.** I went deep on the methodology and the value. The GTM playbook, BU one-pager, and practice mapping are the next layer, once we align on this.
- 5 “XLA by Design” is a proposed name.** Working title to align with Vishal — open for input, not decided.

So as you watch: react to the **thinking**, and tell me where it needs DWS's reality to be true — ServiceNow, delivery, the practice model. That's what turns this from a Launch POV into our joint offering.

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— WHERE WE'RE COMING FROM

The SLA world measures the **work**.

A real floor — honestly measured, keeps the lights on.

- Tickets closed on time. Systems reported available. Response within target.
- The shelf approach packages that floor: **fixed scope, fixed weeks, fixed price**.
- Predictable to buy, predictable to deliver. Nothing wrong with a floor.
- The shift: the buyer now wants **the ceiling** — and the floor can't reach it.



— THE CRACK IN THAT WORLD

Green SLAs. Red outcomes.

Everyone knows this company. Calls answered, trucks rolled, tickets closed — every operational target green. And it's a punchline for customer frustration. The scoreboard says fine; the business says otherwise.

SLA · ACTIVITY	Calls answered in 30s · issues "resolved" · trucks dispatched	ALL GREEN
EXPERIENCE	Cancel-intent calls · "I dread calling" · pressing 0 to escape	UNMEASURED
BUSINESS OUTCOME	Churn to cord-cutting · regulatory complaints · switching to competitors	RED

The SLA layer hits every target while the outcome that pays the bills bleeds. **The experience in the middle is the part nobody measured — and it's the part that moves the outcome.** The



— THE SHIFT

Experience isn't **correlated** with the outcome. It's **how the outcome gets achieved.**

- The familiar read: "experience drives outcomes" — measure it because it moves alongside the result.
- The real read: **you can't hit the number without designing the experience that produces it.**
- Reduce tickets — *how*, if you haven't designed away the reason people file them?



— THE LAUNCH POINT OF VIEW

An SLA is a promise about how people will behave. You can't keep it without designing for the person.

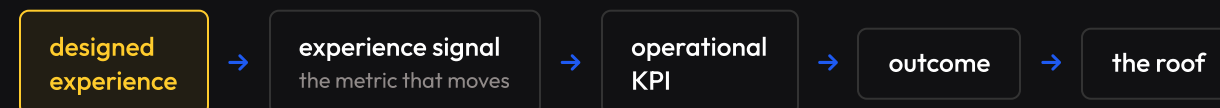
Miss the experience, miss the number. Experience isn't a layer on top of the outcome — it's what makes the outcome reachable at all.



WHAT WE BELIEVE — AND WHY WE LEAD WITH IT

SLAs can't be met without designing the experience.

So we **lead with experience** — and let it drive everything downstream.



Lead anywhere else on that chain and you're measuring the symptom. Lead with the experience and the whole chain becomes reachable.



THE OFFERING

XLA by Design

The experience isn't **surveyed**. It's **designed** — to the metric that moves the outcome.



— HOW THIS FITS WITH DWS — WE ENHANCE, WE DON'T COMPETE

DWS names the destination. We're **how you get there.**

The NTT DATA DWS point of view already maps SLAs → XLAs → outcomes, with persona journeys and a full traceability chain. That blueprint is right. XLA by Design is the **execution discipline** that makes it real on a specific client — the metric found in real behavior, the conversion proven in dollars. We're not a competing framework; we're the muscle behind theirs.

DWS EXPERIENCE PILLARS — THE FRAMEWORK

People experiences
Care teams, staff, leaders — engaged and supported.

Operational experiences
Secure, connected, reliable operations.

Technology experiences
Modern tools, automation, care coordination.

SLAS → XLAS
THE ARROW LAUNCH
SUPPLIES



XLA BY DESIGN — THE ENABLEMENT LAYER

We design the experience that turns each pillar into a measurable, met XLA.

For every pillar, we find the metric that moves, wire it to the outcome, and carry the conversion to the roof. DWS runs the service and reports the SLA. We make the SLA reachable — and the XLA real. Their framework asserts SLAs → XLAs; we're the part that does the arrow.

We don't replace a single thing in their model. **We make the experience layer it promises actually deliverable.** The persona journeys Alexis built are exactly the input this method runs on — XLA by Design makes that work load-bearing, not decorative.

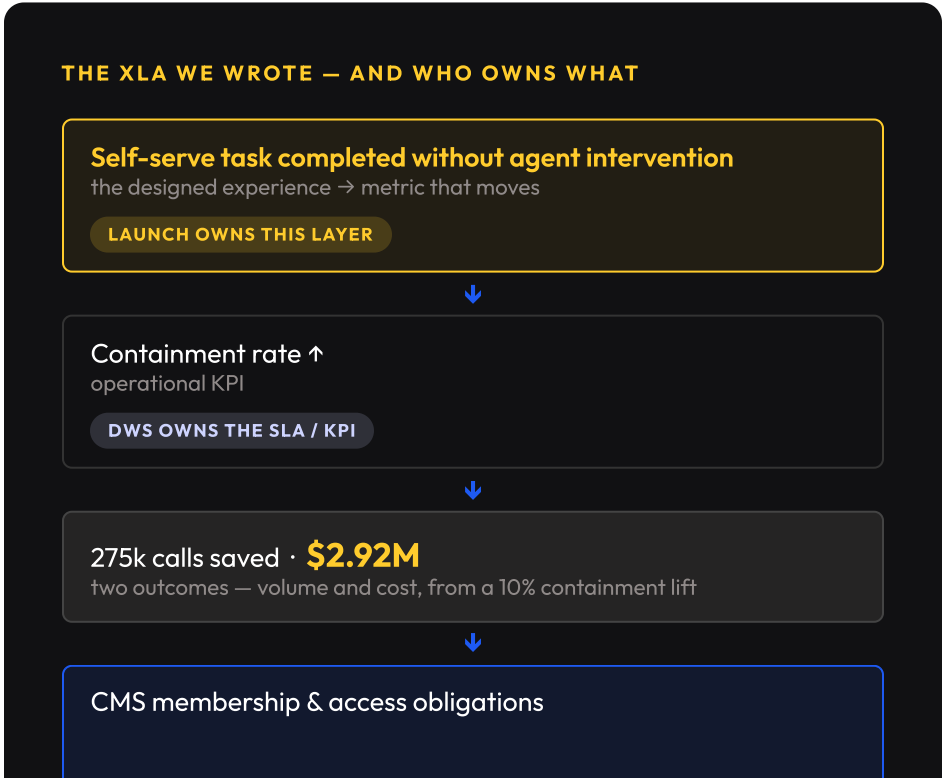
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— WE ARE ENABLEMENT — LAUNCH OWNS THE EXPERIENCE LAYER

We don't run the SLA. We design the experience that makes it movable.

THE GOAL	Cut the cost of Medicare calls — reach >60% authentication , more self-serve, fewer transfers.
THE PROBLEM	Couldn't get there. 37% authentication, 82% transferred to an agent. The IVR contained almost nothing.
THE DIAGNOSIS	Members were pressing 0 to escape the IVR — a behavioral tell (qualitative). The funnel data then proved containment was the lever and sized it (quantitative). Tell + data, converging on one number.
THE METRIC	Containment rate — converted into a contractable XLA.



the roof — the regulatory entitlement the program is measured and paid against

Launch designs the experience that makes the KPI movable. DWS runs and reports the KPI. The experience layer is what turns their SLA into a met one.

Finding the metric that moves is the differentiation. Not the personas — those are table stakes. The art is the craft of finding the one behavioral number that, when it moves, makes the outcome reachable — analyze from how people behave *and* proven in the data. That's qualitative and quantitative, and it can't be copied off a slide.

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— THE TRAP — AND WHY WE DON'T FALL IN IT

A vanity metric vs. a metric that matters.

Here's the mistake the whole category makes — and the one our competitors will make on this exact kind of deal. **It's easy to build an experience score that measures itself. It's hard to find the number wired to a dollar.**

We know the difference because we look for it on purpose.

× THE VANITY METRIC

A rising "Experience Score" (EIS)

A 0–100 composite that rolls sentiment and sub-scores into one index. The roof becomes “the score went up.” Feels rigorous — dashboards, weightings, trends — but it terminates in itself.

→ THE METRIC THAT MATTERS

A behavioral count wired to the dollar

The one thing people *do* when the experience fails — already counted — proven in the data to move the outcome the buyer is accountable for.

Why it fails the test: **a higher score isn't a business outcome.** It's the sentiment tier in a new costume — measuring experience against itself, not against the dollar the buyer must defend. “Confidence 63 → target 80” is a feeling with a target painted on.

Device not ready Day 1 → 108 new hires × 2.1-day wait → **\$62K productivity loss** → attrition the bank is trying to stop

Why it wins: **it converts to money and it can't be gamed.** The score can drift green while this stays red — which is exactly the gap that costs the client.

Everyone can build the score. **Finding the metric that matters is the discipline — and the moat.**

The Experience Score isn't a strawman — it's the most common pattern in the category, including in our own strongest work. Naming the trap is how we make sure we engineer past it on every engagement.

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— WE'RE ALREADY DOING THIS — DEAL BY DEAL

Launch has run this play five times. **We just never named it.**

Every one of these started the same way — ground the people, design the experience, wire it to a DWS outcome — and was **rebuilt from scratch each time.** The spine doesn't invent a new motion. It names the one we keep improvising.

Google

EX storyline for a competitive DWS bid

Ingredion

Live EX/DWS engagement — Launch + DWS delivered together

US Bank

Service Café redesign ahead of a DWS renewal

Amgen

Smart Refresh — device-lifecycle UX & research

Chick-fil-A

DWS-led MSP RFP, live now — due 6/17

“Similar to past EX persona work for DWS... will require some customization from what we've assembled before, but tons of overlap — we should be able to apply it here.”

— from the Chick-fil-A deal brief. That sentence is the whole case: a method we re-apply and re-customize every time, with no name and no structure.

This is the answer to “is it one offering or several?” — **one spine, many roofs**. Formalizing it makes it repeatable and flexible, instead of rebuilt by hand on every deal.

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— THE METHODOLOGY

Four stages. Each one builds a link in the chain.

1

Persona Discovery

BUILDS: DESIGNED EXPERIENCE

2

Experience Design

FINDS: SIGNAL + METRIC

3

Delivery & Measurement

PROVES: SIGNAL → OUTCOME

4

Continuous Innovation

KEEPS: THE CHAIN LIVE

Ground the real person — shadow the work, analyze the data already there. Find the tell and the number it moves.

Design the future state. Identify the metric that moves; locate where the value is.

Instrument the behavioral signal; carry the conversion arithmetic to the roof.

Re-validate as the client and the roof change. Where the multi-year relationship lives.

Before stage 1 — a diagnostic, not delivery. Known vertical (we already have the roof and the chain) or a new one (we build it first)? That read sets the scope — which is exactly why it can't be pre-priced as a package.

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— THE OBJECTION WE NEED TO ANSWER

Repeatable — without being a template.

This is repeatable because it establishes a methodology for designing an XLA experience — not a fixed engagement to resell.

WHAT DOES NOT REPEAT

WHAT DOES REPEAT

The engagement itself. We never stamp the same scope, the same weeks, the same deliverables on two clients. That's the template trap — and it's what caps the money.

The **method for designing the XLA experience**. The diagnostic, the four stages, the way we find the metric that moves. It runs every time — and produces a different, right-sized engagement each time.

The method is the asset. **The diagnostic is the product. The engagement is its output.**

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APPLIED — HOW THE METHOD READS YOUR LIVE DEALS

Same spine. Different roof.

The IVR was the proof it works. Here's the method applied to the deals in this room — the roof changes, the chain re-derives to reach it.

HEALTHCARE · KEENA

Value-Based Care

PROBLEM

Clinicians lose time-to-care to EHR friction — and that friction surfaces as readmissions and missed quality gaps the hospital is penalized for.

UTILITIES · NATHAN · CON EDISON (\$90M RFP)

Grid Reliability

PROBLEM

Field & control-room crews lose time to tooling friction — and under performance-based rates, service & reliability misses become negative revenue adjustments off the authorized return.

VALUE	We make the experience measurable as <i>behavior</i> wired to the penalty — defending real Medicare dollars, not just surveying sentiment. e.g. 48-hr post-discharge follow-up completion — the behavioral count that predicts the readmission HRRP penalizes.
SIGNAL	After-hours EHR minutes · care-gap closure
ROOF	HRRP ($\leq 3\%$ of Medicare inpatient pay) · MIPS band · CAHPS

VALUE	We design the experience that moves the reliability behavior the rate plan measures — turning a compliance exposure into defensible performance. e.g. field-work re-roll rate — the behavioral count that moves the reliability metric the rate plan pays on.
SIGNAL	Workarounds / re-logins per shift (<i>hypothesis — discovery confirms</i>)
ROOF	Performance-based rates — negative revenue adjustments for service/reliability misses

Healthcare is grounded — the roof is real CMS penalty exposure, and the chain matches the DWS POV. Utilities is the live one: the roof is confirmed in Con Ed's rate filings; the behavioral signal is the hypothesis discovery would confirm. **Nathan — want to run the metric-that-moves discovery on Con Ed? Let's find the number that wins the RFP.**

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ILLUSTRATIVE — THE UNIT MATH

How do you size an **XLA by Design** engagement?

We size it from the persona as the unit — not from a calendar. Here's the shape of the math; plug in the real numbers per pursuit. The point is what it reveals about the floor.

1 · DISCOVERY	2 · EXPERIENCE DESIGN ≈ 2 weeks per workflow	3 · DELIVERY & MEASUREMENT Engineering + dashboard	4 · CONTINUOUS Standing analyst cadence
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10 personas × 5 subjects = **50**

interviews

At a 1:3 ratio (prep · talk · synthesize) ≈ **150 hrs**
— before walk-the-mile, shadowing, and the
data analysis where the metric is found.
Researchers + analysts.

The designer from each persona carries
continuity in from Phase 1. Scales with the
number of workflows redesigned.

Instrument the behavioral signal, build the
measurement. Engineering enters here.

Monitoring keeps the chain live — the multi-
year line.

At a **\$200/hr** blended rate, discovery interviews alone (150 hrs) ≈ **\$30K** — one slice of one phase.

The floor lands well north of a pre-priced package — and **every persona you add scales it**.

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— SO — TO BE CLEAR ABOUT WHAT YOU'RE BUYING

This isn't a template. **That's the point.**

Now that you've seen the method and the math, here's why it's priced to the outcome, not the calendar — and why that's the strength, not the catch.

- Pre-sized engagements present as menu items. Packages may read as commodity — savvy buyers discount them. Premiums are paid on outcomes.

- The pursuit team is tasked with **designing the outcome — and the engagement that meets it.**
- That could be a **\$300K** engagement. It could be a **\$3M** one. The outcome decides, not a calendar.

WHY PRE-SIZING WOULD LEAVE MONEY ON THE TABLE

A \$20M offering sold at \$300K a pop needs **66 engagements** — at 8 weeks each, that's **530+ weeks** $\approx$ a **decade**, or only $\sim$ \$2M a year. Pre-sizing caps the program. The math doesn't math.

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OPEN — LET'S DECIDE TOGETHER

The questions the unit-math doesn't answer yet.

The math gives us a floor. We need an operating model.

- 1 **Who sizes it?** The practice / pursuit lead owns effort and duration against the outcome — what does that authority look like?

2 **What seniority where?** Discovery and the metric-that-moves work need real analytical skill set up front — is the blended rate the right model, or do phases carry different rates?

3 **How do we resource "leave no stone unturned"** without it going open-ended? Where's the discipline that keeps it staged, not endless?

The current pursuits - Keena and Nathan is where this gets real. The cleanest way to answer these is to pilot the operating model on a live account. Pursuit team will figure out the staffing there.

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— WHY THIS LEADS TO BIGGER, BETTER DEALS

Outcome-priced. Multi-year. We own the loop.

Uncapped

Sticky

Defensible

Priced to the outcome, not the calendar — the deal scales with the value.

Stage 4 keeps the chain live. The relationship renews because the measurement never stops.

The metric that moves is ours — the thing a competitor can't template.

So — is this the right read? **That's the signal I'm after.**

